SPROUT 2.0

Making first-time investing feel simple

UI/UX Hiring Assignment • Mobile-first fintech experience

Design direction: calm, premium, transparent and beginner-first.

01 — Problem & opportunity

Core problem hypothesis: First-time investors can hesitate before KYC because they are uncertain about what they need, why information is required, and whether the app is still working.

The strongest opportunity is not adding more features. It is reducing uncertainty at the moments where users are most likely to leave.

• Make requirements visible before KYC.

• Explain why sensitive details are requested.

• Turn waiting into a clear system status.

• Keep the first action small: start from ■100.

02 — Data audit & funnel

Metric	Signal	Design implication
40,000 downloads	Top-of-funnel	Strong first impression, but do not over-index on bounce.
9,000 KYC	Major drop before KYC	Reduce uncertainty and preparation friction.
3,000 first investments	Activation gap	Make the journey coherent beyond KYC.
62% KYC drop-off	High-risk moment	Prioritize readiness + KYC clarity.
91% mobile	Primary device	Design mobile-first.
6.2s on 4G	Performance issue	Use lightweight assets and restrained motion.

Data caution: the 78% bounce metric may be inflated by paid acquisition, and the Hindi preference survey represents only 40 existing users. These are treated as directional evidence, not universal truth.

03 — Personas

Persona A — First-time professional
22, early-career, uses a budget Android phone, wants to start small, fears making an irreversible mistake.

Persona B — Clarity-seeking beginner
Prefers simple language, may be more comfortable in Hindi, wants to understand why KYC details are needed before sharing them.

Shared need: confidence through clear sequencing, not financial jargon.

04 — Journey map

Stage	User thought	Risk	UX response
Discover	Can I start small?	Distrust	■100 + transparent positioning
Prepare	What do I need?	Not ready	PAN/Aadhaar checklist
Verify	Why do you need this?	Privacy anxiety	Why we ask + security cue
Wait	Did it work?	Looks broken	Status + time estimate + notification
Return	What happens next?	Uncertainty	Clear completion state

05 — Stakeholder decisions

- CEO vs mascot: use a geometric guide, not a cartoon character.
- Marketing vs performance: no autoplay video, ticker or pop-up stack; preserve the single task.
- Compliance vs conversion: keep the risk disclaimer visible and readable rather than hiding it.
- Developer vs delight: use SVG and CSS-first motion; keep the interaction system small.
- Support vs waiting state: explicit progress/status replaces an ambiguous spinner.

06 — UX strategy & IA

Homepage → Start with ■100 → Welcome → What you need → Mobile/OTP → KYC → Verification waiting → Notification/return.

The flow intentionally answers three questions in order: **What is this? What do I need? What is happening now?**

07 — Visual direction & mascot

The visual system uses a warm canvas, deep green primary action, quiet borders and high-contrast ink. The mascot is a geometric sprout with four states: welcome, explaining, waiting and celebration.

The mascot is supportive rather than decorative: it carries the emotional state of the flow without turning the product into a cartoon.

08 — Homepage

Mobile prioritizes the hero, one CTA, trust, and the above-the-fold risk disclosure. Desktop expands the same hierarchy into a spacious two-column composition.

The 'How it works' section and readiness checklist directly address uncertainty before KYC.

09 — Onboarding

Five screens form one continuous narrative: welcome → readiness → mobile verification → KYC → waiting.

The fifth screen is intentionally simple. Its primary job is to make waiting legible: current status, approximate time, and notification expectation.

10 — Metrics & experiments

• Download → KYC conversion rate

• KYC abandonment rate

• Median KYC completion time

• OTP/KYC error rate

• Waiting-screen abandonment

• First investment conversion

A/B tests: earlier readiness checklist vs later checklist; concise vs explanatory hero; static waiting status vs progress-based waiting state.

11 — Final rationale

Sprout 2.0 is designed around a simple product principle: **reduce uncertainty before asking for commitment.**

The final experience is intentionally lightweight, accessible, Hindi-ready and feasible for a single frontend developer within a short launch window.

Submission package includes Figma-ready SVG screens, mascot states, design tokens, and a clickable HTML prototype.